Like JavaScript, a regular expression literal in CoffeeScript begins and ends with a forward slash `/`:

```
/abc/
# /abc/
```

Unlike JavaScript, though, a regular expression must not start with a literal space:

```
/ abc/
# error: unexpected /
```

Once you have expressions, you need a way to name things. You need variables.

### 2.2.2. Variables

Names that refer to local values are called *variables*. A name should contain only letters, numbers, and underscores. Other characters are permitted, such as π (pi) and $ (dollar sign), but you don't need them. A variable name must not be one of the reserved names. A list of reserved words that you can't use for names is in appendix A.

#### Undefined

When you use a name that hasn't had any value assigned to it, you get an error telling you that the name is not defined:

```
pegasus
# ReferenceError: pegasus is not defined
```

Names that aren't defined have a special type called *undefined*. To define a variable, you assign a value to a name. This causes the variable to *reference* that value:

```
answer = 42
neighborOfTheBeast = 668
blameItOnTheBoogie = yes
texasRanger = {actor: 'Chuck Norris'}
```